rise of the Shunga dynasty in what is now West Bengal and Bihar in the second century BCE. But that is another story, still waiting for another historian to write.

The tenth and last of the Shunga rulers, Raja Devabuti, followed precedent by being assassinated by his chief minister, Vasudeva Kanva, who then founded his own short-lived Kanva dynasty in about 80 BCE. But soon afterwards the fourth and last of the Kanvas was himself overthrown by a new power in South India, named in the Puranas as the Andhras but better known today by the name they gave themselves: the Satavahanas, who to this day remain perhaps the most undervalued of all the great dynasties of Indian kings.